

Final Project Charter Rubric

(all items should meet at least a satisfactory level (70%) but your true goal is to exceed expectations and achieve excellence)

Reviewer: _____

Date: _____

Team/Members: _____

Category	Excellent (90–100%)	Proficient (80–89%)	Evolving (70–79%)	In Progress (<70%)	Weight
1. Problem Definition & Objectives	Clearly identifies an open-ended, data-engineering problem; objectives are measurable, achievable, and aligned with sponsor goals.	Problem and objectives are mostly clear but may lack precision or measurable outcomes.	Problem is vaguely defined; objectives incomplete or not clearly measurable.	Problem statement unclear or misaligned with sponsor needs.	15%
2. Scope & Boundaries	Defines clear project scope, constraints, and assumptions; effectively prevents scope creep. Presents a well-defined structure, conceptual model, and/or framework ¹ .	Defines scope and constraints but may overlook minor details.	Scope is broad or missing constraints.	No clear scope or boundaries; project lacks focus.	10%
3. Stakeholders & Authority	Accurately lists sponsor, advisor, and team roles with defined responsibilities and communication plan; includes sponsor sign-off.	Stakeholders identified with some clarity issues in roles or authority.	Some stakeholders or responsibilities missing.	Stakeholders not identified or misrepresented.	10%
4. Data & Resources	Identifies all required datasets, tools, methods, and technologies; discusses access, quality, and ethical considerations.	Lists key data and tools but lacks detail on access or ethics.	Mentions data sources but with limited analysis.	Data sources and resources unclear or missing.	10%
5. Project Plan & Timeline	Detailed, feasible timeline with milestones and deliverables aligned with semester schedule; shows understanding of dependencies.	Reasonable timeline with most milestones identified.	Timeline is generic or incomplete.	No clear timeline or deliverables.	15%
6. Risks & Constraints	Identifies major technical, ethical, and logistical risks with mitigation strategies.	Identifies some risks but limited mitigation discussion.	Risks are vague or unrealistic.	Risks not identified.	10%
7. Ethical, Legal & Standards Considerations	Explicitly discusses relevant standards, ethical, and privacy issues in data engineering.	Mentions key issues but lacks depth.	Minimal attention to ethics or standards.	Omits ethical and standards considerations.	10%
8. Clarity & Professionalism	Well-organized, concise, and polished; suitable for sponsor and academic audiences; uses professional formatting and references.	Mostly clear and professional; minor formatting issues.	Somewhat disorganized or unclear sections.	Poorly written or formatted; lacks coherence.	10%
9. Sponsor & Advisor Interaction	Demonstrates meaningful collaboration and documented feedback integration from sponsor/advisor.	Shows engagement but feedback not fully integrated.	Minimal sponsor/advisor interaction evident.	No evidence of engagement or feedback.	10%

Weights:

- **Draft 1 (S/U):** Focus on problem statement, objectives, scope, and initial plan.
- **Draft 2 (S/U):** Incorporate feedback; refine data plan, risks, and timeline.
- **Final Charter (70%):** Fully developed, sponsor-approved document ready for DAEN 460 implementation.
- **Presentation (10%):** Evaluates communication of the project plan and sponsor engagement.
- **Peer Review (5%):** Reviewed by team members to ensure active participation, professionalism, and collaboration throughout the project.
- **Sponsor Review (5%):** Reviewed by the project sponsor to verify that the project objectives, scope, and deliverables align with organizational needs and expectations.
- **Advisor Review (5%):** Evaluated by the project advisor for technical soundness and feasibility of the proposed plan.
- **Instructor Review (5%):** Assessed by the course instructor for compliance with course requirements and academic standards.

¹A high-level representation of a system or idea that simplifies complexity by showing the main components and their relationships. Emphasize/showcase the proposed solution acting as a facilitator/driver/enabler of the project objectives.